

DECLUTTER BEYOND

The Declutter Beyond Toolkit

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The Four-Area Assessment Worksheets



These worksheets are the written version of the Honest Inventory and the Honest Cost Assessment from Chapter 3. This Toolkit also includes the full 30-Day Unstuck Protocol. Use them before you begin clearing each area. The act of writing is not optional — it is what makes the assessment honest rather than approximate.

WORKSHEET 1

Your Time



The Inventory

Complete the Time Vision Exercise in Chapter 4 before beginning this inventory.

List every recurring commitment currently on your calendar — professional, personal, and social. Include the ones you've stopped listing because they feel fixed.

For each commitment, note: Did I actively choose this, or did it happen to me over time?

When you look at the full picture of your calendar, what is the feeling that arrives — capable, or heavy?

Sort each commitment: Essential / Valuable But Not Essential / Neither.

The Cost Assessment

What is the time cost of your current calendar — how many hours per week are consumed by commitments you didn't consciously choose?

What is the energy cost — the cognitive and emotional weight of the commitments you're dreading, the transitions, the preparation, the recovery?

What is the opportunity cost — what is not happening in your life because of what is?

What You're Clearing Toward

Complete this sentence: I want my calendar to reflect _____.

WORKSHEET 2

Your Digital Life



The Inventory

List every email account, social media platform, messaging app, and group chat you currently maintain.

For each: Does this serve my life as it is right now?

Where is the digital clutter most severe — inbox, social media, devices, subscriptions? (For inbox and notifications, refer to the Triage Architecture; for devices, the Device and Account Audit; for subscriptions, the Digital Subscription Test — all in Chapter 5.)

How many digital subscriptions are you currently paying for? List every one you can name. The ones you can't name are important too — they will surface in the Cost Assessment.

Estimate the total number of unread emails across all accounts. Write it down.

The Cost Assessment

Which apps are interrupting your attention on their schedule rather than yours — and which notifications could be turned off without any real loss?

Which content are you scrolling past without choosing — feeds, newsletters, or platforms you consume passively rather than intentionally?

What is the ongoing energy cost of maintaining a digital life that is larger than what you actually use?

What You're Clearing Toward

Complete this sentence: I want my digital life to reflect _____.

WORKSHEET 3

Your Money



The Inventory

List every recurring subscription and recurring charge currently running — including the ones you’ve stopped noticing.

Pull up your bank and credit card statements for the last three months. As you go through every line, note any charge that surprises you.

What spending pattern do you already know is present but haven't yet named or addressed?

The Cost Assessment

What is the monthly cost of commitments you didn't actively choose — subscriptions, defaults, habits?

Which of the three financial clutter levels is most active in your life right now: visible clutter (subscriptions and recurring charges), invisible clutter (spending that doesn't announce itself), or systemic clutter (the underlying pattern of acquisition)?

What You're Clearing Toward

Complete this sentence: I want my financial life to reflect _____.

WORKSHEET 4

Your Relationships



The Inventory

List the social commitments that are currently recurring in your life — regular dinners, standing plans, group memberships, obligatory events.

For each: Is this a Chosen obligation (an obligation you'd take on again today and don't experience as a drain), a Drifted obligation (once chosen, but changed in ways you haven't yet acknowledged), or an Accumulated obligation (something you never chose but have been maintaining)?

For each commitment: would you say yes to this today, knowing what the ongoing commitment actually looks like, if you were deciding from scratch?

The Cost Assessment

For each commitment, ask: how do you feel in the twenty-four hours before this? Assign each one to a category: Sustaining (adds more than it costs), Neutral (neither drains nor replenishes), or Draining (costs more than it returns).

What is the cumulative energy cost of maintaining social obligations that have outlasted the relationships that gave them meaning?

What You're Clearing Toward

Complete this sentence: I want my social life to reflect _____.

The 30-Day Unstuck Protocol



Chapter 3 introduced the core version of this protocol: note the item, set a thirty-day reminder, and let time answer the question for you. That version works when you're genuinely undecided — when you don't yet know whether something still belongs in your life.

This is the expanded version, for a different kind of stuck. Use it when you've already made the decision but can't act on it — when you know what needs to go, or what needs to change, and thirty days of waiting won't tell you anything you don't already know. The thirty days here don't defer the decision — they reveal why you haven't moved on one you've already made. It is not a motivational system. It is a diagnostic — a way of figuring out why you're stuck and addressing the specific reason rather than applying general effort.

Stuckness in clearing work has three common sources: the decision feels too large to make at once, the emotional weight of the area is higher than expected, or the systems to support the clearing aren't yet in place. The protocol addresses all three.

Before You Begin: Identify the Specific Block

What, specifically, are you not doing?

Is the block primarily practical (you don't know what to do next), emotional (you know what to do but can't bring yourself to do it), or logistical (external factors are in the way)?

What would need to be true for this to feel like a decision you could make?

The Protocol: Thirty Days, Three Phases

Days 1–10: Shrink the Decision

The most common reason clearing stalls is that the scope of the decision feels total. You're not trying to process one email — you're trying to process what your inbox says about how you've been living. You're not trying to cancel one subscription — you're trying to face what the spending pattern means.

For the first ten days, shrink the decision until it no longer feels like a statement about your life. It is only a small action.

Each day, take one action that is so small it cannot fail: unsubscribe from one list. Decline one thing. Cancel one subscription. Look at one line of the bank statement. Remove one person from one obligation.

Do not try to complete the clearing. Try only to restart the momentum.

At the end of ten days, note what shifted. Often the block was the first action, not the clearing itself.

Days 11–20: Address the Emotional Weight

If the block persists past Day 10, it is carrying more weight than the practical task. This is most common in the relationship and money areas, where the clearing touches identity, not just habit.

For the next ten days, spend five minutes a day writing about the thing you're not clearing. Not about how to clear it — about what it means. The questions below are starting points:

What story am I telling myself about why this can't be released? What do I believe will happen if I let this go?

Whose voice am I hearing when I tell myself I shouldn't?

What would I tell a close friend who was stuck in exactly this place?

You are not trying to solve anything in this phase. You are trying to make the emotional content visible enough that it stops operating below the surface.

Days 21–30: Build the Bridge

If you're still stuck at Day 21, the issue is usually one of two things: either you need a different decision than the one you've been trying to make, or you need external support to make this one.

For the final ten days:

Revisit the Honest Inventory from Chapter 3. Has what you're clearing toward changed since you started? If the vision has shifted, the clearing decision may need to shift with it.

Identify one person — a friend, a partner, a professional if the area warrants it — who can help you think through what you're stuck on. Not to decide for you, but to hear you think out loud.

If the block is specifically financial or relational, consider whether a professional resource (a financial advisor, a therapist) would make the decision more possible. There is no shame in that. Some weight is too much to move alone.

A Note on What This Protocol Is Not

The 30-Day Unstuck Protocol is not a way of forcing yourself through something you've genuinely decided isn't ready. Some things need more time. Some commitments need to run their natural course before they can be released. Some financial changes require external steps before they're possible.

If you work through all thirty days and find that the clearing still isn't happening, it is worth asking: am I stuck, or have I actually made a different decision than the one I started with? Both are real. The protocol is designed to make the difference visible — not to override your own judgment about what you're actually ready to do.